

2025

ANNUAL REPORT

**CORNERSTONE
CRAFTSMAN**



**CORNERSTONE
CRAFTSMAN**



Our First Year of Impact.

www.cornerstonecraftsman.org

2111 Eisenhower Avenue, Suite 102, Alexandria, VA, 22314, USA



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On behalf of everyone at Cornerstone Craftsman, thank you for your generous support. Because of our supporters, young people facing significant challenges are finding opportunity, stability, and hope for the future.

Your generosity has enabled us to reach important milestones this year. With your support, we have expanded our network to serve 28 youth, who now participate in our program on a weekly basis. To address food insecurity in their households, we provide groceries to over 120 individuals, helping ensure that basic needs are met so our youth can focus on growth and learning.

We are also proud to have developed a new resource center—the Learning Lab—which offers academic tutoring for our pre-apprentices, along with résumé-building workshops and interview preparation for those actively seeking employment. These services reflect our holistic approach: not only preparing youth for careers in the skilled trades, but changing the trajectory of their lives by breaking cycles of poverty and reducing the risk of recidivism.

Because of your support, families have food on the table and young people are building brighter futures. Our youth are launching their own LLCs, connecting with potential employers, receiving advocacy in court, and successfully completing probation—avoiding re-entry into the juvenile justice system. These stories of hope and transformation are possible because you chose to invest in them.

Looking ahead, we are excited to continue building on this momentum. With continued partnership, we aim to expand our grocery delivery network, strengthen our educational and workforce development programs, and deepen our impact across the community we serve.

Thank you for believing in our mission and for standing with Cornerstone Craftsman. Your generosity fuels real change, and we are deeply grateful to have you as part of our community.

Sincerely,



Roberto Gomez
Executive Director



A major milestone in 2025 was securing a permanent facility and office space, culminating in the opening of the Cornerstone Craftsman Facility and our Learning Lab career and tutoring center. The grand opening on February 28 marked a significant step forward in creating a dedicated, welcoming environment for youth to learn, collaborate, and grow.



Cornerstone Craftsman enriched youth experiences through exposure, enrichment, and industry access. Participants attended Washington Nationals and D.C. United games, fostering community connection and engagement beyond the classroom.



Cornerstone Craftsman demonstrated strong community support during its first Spring2ACTion campaign, raising \$45,000 and placing 6th among small organizations and 20th overall—an impressive achievement for a first-year non-profit and a testament to the strength of its mission and supporters.

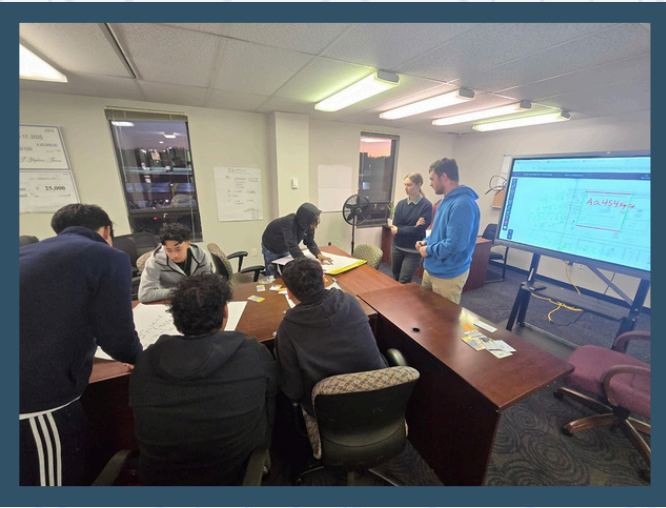


Cornerstone Craftsman experienced a landmark year of growth and recognition in its inaugural year. The organization was honored with the Rising Star of the Year award from the ALX Chamber of Commerce, affirming its early impact within the Alexandria community.



Additionally, our Executive Director, Roberto Gomez, received a prestigious D.C. United Award, recognizing leadership and dedication to youth development and workforce equity. These honors reflect the organization's credibility, momentum, and growing reputation as a trusted partner in workforce development.

Strategic partnerships continued to deepen, including a transformative collaboration with Clark Construction, where youth are actively involved in planning, learning software skills, and implementing a mock room in our facility, in preparation to help build a dedicated room at the Inova at Landmark hospital site.



7 FIELD TRIPS
8 WORKSHOPS

Additional industry exposure included site tours with CoreSite alongside DPR Construction and a behind-the-scenes tour of the Marriott opening with Comstock. Together, these experiences underscore Cornerstone Craftsman's commitment to bridging education, industry, and opportunity for the next generation.



In 2025, Cornerstone Craftsman demonstrated exceptional program strength and youth engagement, serving 36 youth throughout the year and 45 youth overall since launch.

The program currently supports 28 active participants, with demand continuing to grow as evidenced by a waitlist of 51 youth.

**2025- INDUSTRY
RECOGNIZED
CERTIFICATIONS:**
30 youth earned
OSHA-10 certifications
27 youth have been
certified in CPR and
First Aid



**97%
Retention Rate**

Program expansion milestones included the integration of a second cohort in March 2025 and the addition of a dedicated Thursday after-school program.

Through a special partnership with Alexandria's Workforce Development's Summer Youth Employment Program, 6 additional youth joined Cornerstone Craftsman during the summer, further broadening access to career pathways.



OUR YOUTH SUPPORTING THE COMMUNITY

Youth participated in extensive community engagement, including civic advocacy trips to Richmond with Moms Demand Action, mayoral youth forums, Juneteenth celebrations, 19 community cookouts, Narcan and addiction response training, library support projects, and hands-on beautification work at local schools.



"My son has matured and developed a much clearer vision for his future since being a part of the program. He's inspired to pursue entrepreneurship thanks to Mr. Roberto's guidance. He sees himself as a future leader and businessman. As a proud parent, I love seeing my son excited. He's learning valuable skills that will prepare him for whatever comes after high school or college. I'm incredibly grateful to Mr. Roberto for his dedication to these young men. Cornerstone Craftsman is a true example of a 'village' supporting our children's growth."

- A Parent of a Program Participant



PROVIDING EQUITABLE OPPORTUNITIES FOR YOUTH

In 2025, holistic support remained a cornerstone of the program's success.

GROCERY SUPPORT

In partnership with ALIVE!, our organization distributed 4,500 pounds of food to over 120 individuals—including 28 pre-apprentices and their families—providing them with healthy groceries.

ESSENTIAL DOCUMENTATION

In 2025, Cornerstone Craftsman assisted youth in securing essential work and life documentation, including:

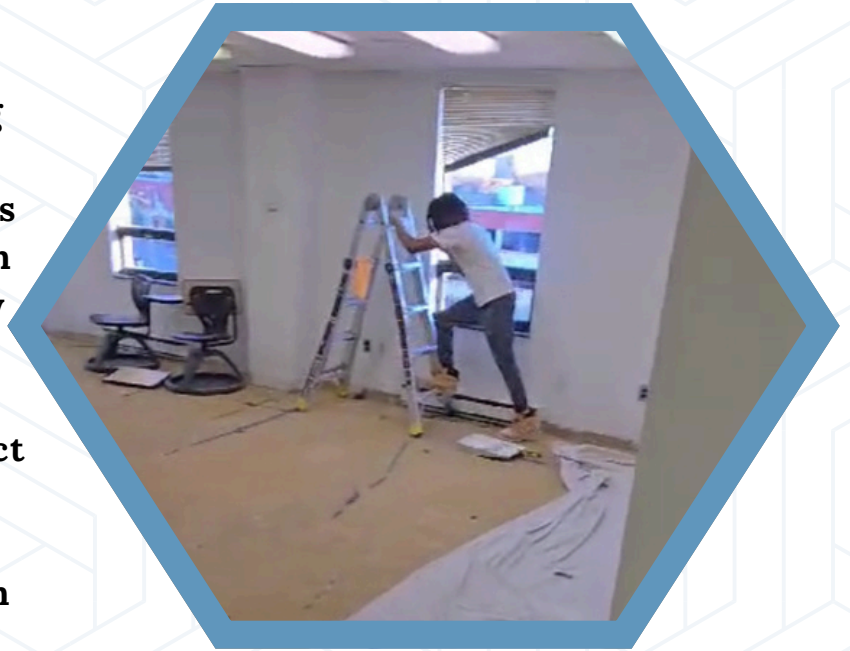
- 3 state IDs
- 4 birth certificates
- 3 driver's education enrollments
- 1 driver's license
- 2 bank accounts

In the summer of 2025, The Learning Lab was launched as both a tutoring and career readiness center. This was done through the support of Simpson Development and Inova's Community Health Fund grant.

This space was created due to the fact that youth in the program needed a safe space where they could understand what they are learning in school. Volunteers tutor youth in courses like Math and Reading mainly, as they are essential skills for youth to comprehend to enter the world of trades.

Youth helped restore this space, using their skills learned in the program to re-do this office space.

This space is now used for tutoring, networking opportunities, and career readiness training.



**All Youth Have
Access to
Tutoring**

**100% success
rate in passing
exams**



Career outcomes and long-term impact were evident throughout the year. Two youth graduated from the program in 2025. One secured a paid apprenticeship with IBEW Local 26, earning \$27.50 per hour with full benefits and a pension. Another successfully completed the program with support from the Learning Lab and transitioned into post-program opportunities.

Additionally, two youth launched their own painting business, Wealthy Walls, building early clientele and gaining real-world entrepreneurial experience.



"I'm 15 and a student at Alexandria City High School. This program has helped me in so many ways. I've learned many new skills that I can use for the future, whatever path I choose. It's also helped me develop my communication skills, making it easier to talk to people. Plus, the program keeps me focused and out of trouble and the streets."

- A Program Participant





Cornerstone Craftsman has a strong history of supporting court-involved youth, having worked with 12 young people navigating the juvenile justice system, receiving direct advocacy and ongoing support through our program. In 2025, our team attended more than 30 court dates, standing alongside youth and their families to ensure access to opportunity, accountability, and fair outcomes. Through consistent presence, documentation support, workforce preparation, and mentorship, Cornerstone Craftsman successfully advocated for positive resolutions in these eight cases, helping youth remain in their communities and on a path toward stability and success.

Our court-involved youth that have thrived in our program are a powerful example of what's possible when support, opportunity, and accountability come together. We're proud of the transformation they have made—and grateful for everyone who helped make it possible.

"Youth I supervise that engage in the [CC] program have noticeably positive changes in their attitudes and behaviors. I've also noticed that youth in the program have not reoffended. I'm grateful that the kids in this City have an opportunity like this pre-apprenticeship program—it is the only one [of its kind] I know of in Alexandria City."

— Probation Officer, David Klem



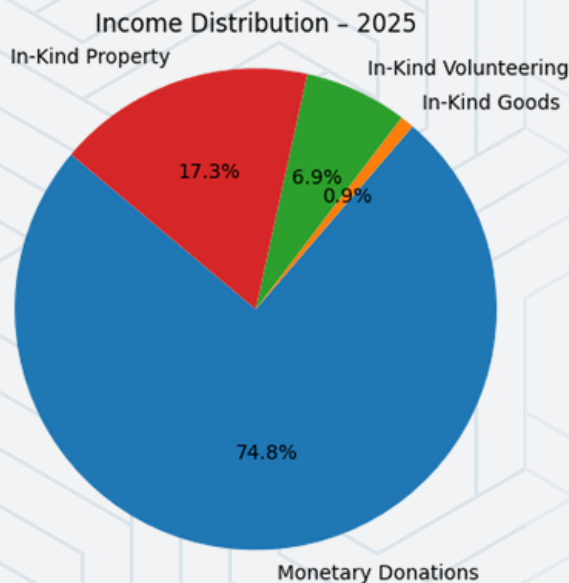


One powerful example of this impact is the story of a pre-apprentice who was granted early termination of probation—an outcome the court described as rare. In December 2024, with advocacy from Cornerstone Craftsman and community support, this young person was released from juvenile detention on bond and placed into our pre-apprenticeship program. In March, rather than being sentenced to juvenile prison until age 21, he was placed on indefinite probation, with his case scheduled for review in October 2025. During this period, our team provided consistent guidance and opportunities for growth, both inside and outside the courtroom.

Throughout 2025, this young man demonstrated remarkable progress. He excelled academically, secured part-time employment to support his household, and deepened his commitment to personal development and community engagement by serving on multiple city initiatives—all while remaining under court supervision. By October 2025, his sustained efforts and growth were undeniable. The judge ultimately made the rare decision of dismissing his felony charges and terminated his probation entirely, allowing him to move forward without a criminal record and with a true second chance. As the judge noted, such outcomes are highly unusual—but in this case, he saw

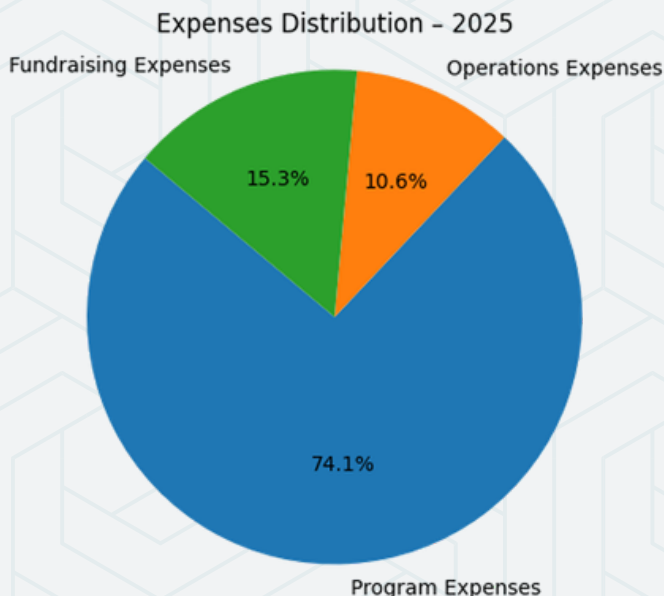
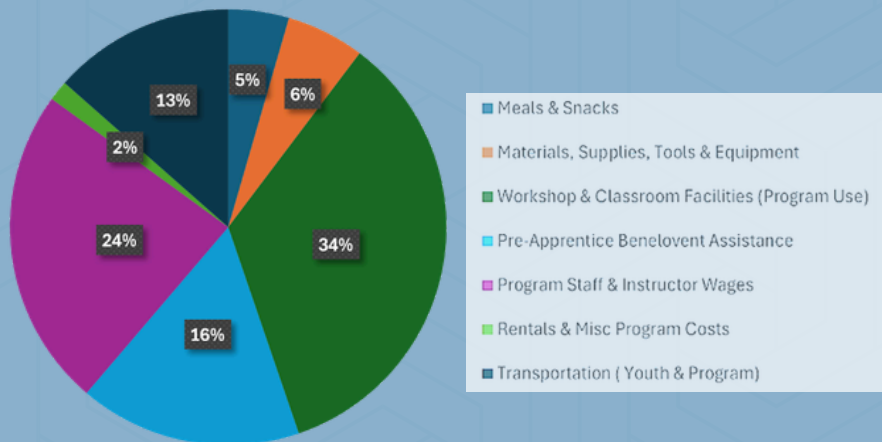
genuine, lasting change in the young man's life. This outcome reflects Cornerstone Craftsman's mission in action: when mentorship, education, workforce pathways, and accountability align, young people can not only avoid further justice system involvement—but truly thrive.





In its first year of operation, Cornerstone Craftsman was proud to be supported through a combination of public, private, and foundation funding. In 2025, the organization generated total income of **\$512,513.47**, including an in-kind donation for our facility. Excluding in-kind donations, Cornerstone generated a total of **\$383,471.30**.

Cornerstone Craftsman incurred total expenses of **\$423,569.94**, resulting in a net income of **\$88,943.53**. Notably, 74% of all expenses directly supported our programs and holistic services for youth enrolled in our long-term workforce development model.



These investments extended beyond trade skill instruction to include civic engagement opportunities, educational field trips, and essential supports such as meals and assistance with required work documentation, including state-issued IDs. This strong financial foundation reflects Cornerstone Craftsman's commitment to responsible stewardship and meaningful, youth-centered impact.

Donor List-Individuals

\$1000 and More:

- Anonymous — \$1,000
- Anonymous — \$1,500
- Anonymous — \$2,500
- Amelia Chasse Alcivar
- Amy Stratford Barker
- Harry Deringer
- Demarco Eberhardt
- Stephanie Elms
- Jennifer and Tim Gale
- Susan Hepler
- Charles Holt
- Kelly Johnson
- Kelly Thomasson and Clark Mercer
- Sue and Graham Setliff
- Donnie Simpson
- Francis and Hillary Stiff
- Andrea and Tobin Tracey
- Ricardo Valverde
- Ron Vassallo
- Lisa Wolford
- David Wynne

\$500 and More:

- Anonymous
- The Readers of ALXtra
- Catie Brownback
- Mason Butler
- Jane Carlson
- Kloe Cella
- Chris DeBosier
- Gabe Elias
- Stephanie Elms
- Kate Finamore
- Bryan Kirkes
- Taylor Lawch
- Al Martzloff
- Clark Mercer
- Mystic Bar and Grill
- Greg Parks
- Royal Restaurant
- Samuel Rust
- Sean Sherlock
- Walter Tyree
- Justin Wilson

Monthly/ Continuous Donors

- Anonymous
- Catie Brownback
- Mason Butler
- Sean Casey
- Amelia Chasse
- Gabriel Elias
- Stephanie Elms
- Katy Fike
- Marianne Hawn
- Kathy Neilson
- Rachel Nixon
- Sarah Quinones
- Jessica Robertson
- Dan Roth
- Jessica Sarra & Jim Stunkle

"In today's current times it is not hard to find negative articles or news regarding our youth. Our youth is our future and should be nurtured, helped and appreciated. When I heard about the work being done by the Cornerstone Craftsmen organization and then saw it in action, I had to respond by showing my full support and appreciation. It's not everyday that you can be a part of a movement and organization that gives our young people skills and self-worth to not only help themselves, but serve the community with a much needed skill in the marketplace. Please keep up the great work you are doing. You will never fully know the full impact of your work, but rest assured it's a huge one. Many thanks and God Bless you and your wonderful work."

-Ricardo Valverde- Donor

OUR AMAZING ORGANIZATIONAL SUPPORTERS

15



- ACT for Alexandria
- The Adler Foundation
- Alexandria Times
- AT&T
- Burke and Herbert Bank
- Clark Construction
- Cloudbreak Foundation
- The Community Foundation of Northern Virginia
- The Comfort Family Foundation
- D.C United
- Dominion Energy
- DPR Construction
- Fraternal Order of Eagles
- HRP Group
- Inova Health
- JEN Contracting
- Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc
- Northern Virginia Health Foundation
- Old Dominion Boat Club
- Paisano's- Eisenhower Avenue
- Partnership for a Healthier Alexandria
- Rotary Club of Alexandria
- Simpson Development
- Transurban: Express Lanes





UNIONS

- Smart Local 100
- Eastern Atlantic States (EAS) Regional Council of Carpenters
- IBEW Local 26
- Plumbers, Gasfitters United Association Local 5



CORPORATIONS

- Milwaukee
- Clark Construction
- DPR Construction
- Simpson Development
- Comstock
- HRP Group
- EMN Construction
- Mode4 Architecture LLC



NONPROFITS/ OTHER ORGANIZATIONS

- ACPS
- TechByTech
- Moms Demand Action
- Alexandria Chamber of Commerce
- ALIVE! Food Bank
- Alexandria Court Services
- Alexandria Workforce Development Center
- Alexandria Economic Development Partnership
- Inova Health





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Platinum
Transparency
2026

Candid.

2111 Eisenhower Avenue, Suite 102,
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